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SITAR TO ZITAR
Niladri Kumar improvised a five-stringed electric sitar and called it the zitar

Pandit Shiv Kumar Sharma, Ustad Alla Rakha and Pandit Hariprasad Chaurasia. Due to their versatility, several classical musicians, such as Pandit Ram Narayan and Ustad Rais Khan, started playing and singing for films—something unheard of earlier. Indian musicians being recorded on LPs, especially by The Gramophone Company of India, gave a huge fillip to classical music. The growth of music circles—the Dadar Matunga music circle, Vile Parle music circle, among others, in Mumbai—played a huge role in providing a platform to musicians.

1970s

This era saw the emergence of young musicians. **Corporates started entering the classical music world** by way of sponsoring programmes. The Indian Tobacco Company (ITC) founded the Sangeet Research Academy in Kolkata, while the Tatas started the National Centre for Performing Arts and supported musicians. Another pathbreaking move was the launch of the Society for Promotion of Indian Classical Music Among Youth (SPIC-MACAY) by Dr Kiran Seth in 1977. This nationwide movement helped decode the complex world of classical music to school and college students through lecture-demonstrations and concerts. This outreach has been the biggest classical musical influence for the young.

1980s

Gulshan Kumar launched the T-series label, which released covers of popular film songs, sung by the likes of **Sonu Nigam** and Anuradha Paudwal, and also *bhajan*s in the form of affordable cassettes. It also started the trend of remixes that later became a genre.



AFP

1990s

As young singers swelled and there were not enough options to showcase their talent in films, a new genre emerged—Indipop. Independent composers joined hands with young singers to create solo albums with a lot of Western orchestra. Many Indipop stars emerged, notably Daler Mehndi, Shankar Mahadevan, **Alisha Chinai**, Shubha Mudgal and Shujaat Husain Khan. They also released videos on music channels. Apart from AIR, new FM radio channels also came into being and popularised music.

